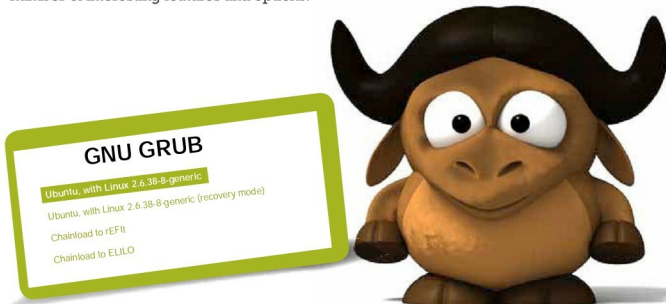


Grub 2 Demystified

A Complete Perspective

Grub, also known as GR and Unified Bootloader, has been the main boot loader for many Linux distributions. Grub was initially released as a part of the GNU HURD project and later was merged in the public repository of the GNU project. It is presently available in two versions—the legacy Grub and the new version marketed as Grub 2, which has a number of interesting features and options.



Grub2 was derived from a project called PUPA. The project's aim was to enhance the GNU boot loader, make the code more secure and provide a robust platform for the end user. The magnitude of changes called for an immediate rewrite of the code from scratch. Grub2, with the completely rewritten code, boasts of a highly modular and secure structure offering a variety of expandable designs.

While newly written code and a completely new design offer many advantages, they also have their own drawbacks. For starters, Grub2 tries to be simple and looks similar to the legacy Grub, providing users with a familiar feeling. The new model brings into play a completely new set-up wizard, which is too perplexing for newbies, while at the same time creating new opportunities for developers to get the most out of the modular design. Here are some of the key features that make Grub2 more sophisticated and easier for developers to maintain.

Scripting support: Grub2 offers scripting support. Developers and users can create custom scripts to carry out specialised functions. Grub2 even allows you to make use of conditional statements.

Dynamic module loading: Boasting of a modular design, Grub2 offers a dynamic module, which means that each and every module can be loaded when needed, during selection time or after it.

Custom menus and themes: Eye candy has never been a Grub feature but with Grub2 developers aim to provide ample leeway for designers to create gorgeous themes.

Support for UUID: Grub2 has native support for UUID (Universal Unique Identifier), providing a more concrete solution to identifying partitions.

A centralised system for rescue and setting up: Grub2 offers even more robust rescue measures in case of some problems.

The above mentioned features provide only a glimpse of what Grub2 is really capable of, covering only some of the newly released features. Such robust features and a completely new approach have unfortunately brought along many drawbacks as well. The incorporation of a new set-up wizard is one. Users conversant with the older configuration wizard will have difficulties getting used to the new one.